

A Day in Evora

Evora is the single most interesting destination in the Alentejo and it's also convenient for the nearby carpet-making town of Arraiolos and the elegant "marble towns" of Estremoz, Borba, and Vila Viçosa.

MORNING Visit the daily **Mercado Municipal** (municipal market) for Alentejan produce, but if possible, also go to the even more impressive open-air market held in Rossio square on the first Tuesday of the month. In the old town, don't miss the majestic **Sé** – the largest medieval cathedral in Portugal – or the Corinthian **Templo Romano** just a short walk away.

AFTERNOON Cafés line the central square, **Praça do Giraldo**, and after coffee and cakes, you can stroll to **São Francisco** church to see its macabre **Capela dos Ossos**, a chapel lined with the skulls and bones of former monks. The pretty public gardens lie beyond.

EVENING Watch the sun set from the outdoor café by the **Templo Romano** before investigating the traditional taverns and local restaurants hidden in the city's medieval alleys.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

From **Lisbon international airport** it's a 90-minute drive east to **Evora**. If you don't want to rent a car, there are direct **buses** and **trains** from downtown Lisbon.

WHERE TO STAY

Residencial Policarpo (inexpensive) is a charming if modest *pension* in a 16th-century manor house. www.pensaopolicarpo.com
Albergaria do Calvário (moderate) has boutique-style rooms in a former olive-oil mill. www.albergariadocalvario.com

Pousada de Evora – Lóios (expensive) is an elegant hotel in an ancient convent building, situated next to the Templo Romano in the center of town. www.pousadas.pt

TOURIST INFORMATION

Praça do Giraldo 73; +351 266 777 071



Right The black pigs of the Alentejo wander the region's oak forests, grazing freely on acorns

Below The view from Estremoz – the largest of the "marble towns" – over the plains of Upper Alentejo

